

Salale university
College of Natural Science
Department of Computer Science

Final Year Project Proposal Writing Guidelines

Academic Year 2022/23

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Project Proposal Writing Guideline

Important note about writing a proposal: Proposals are informative and persuasive writing because they attempt to educate the reader and to convince the reader the importance of the project to be conducted. The goal of the writer is to make the reader believe that the provided solution is practical and appropriate. In persuasive proposal writing, the case is built by demonstration of logic and reason in the approach taken in the solution. The effectiveness of your proposal will depend on your ability to explain the nature, context and scope of your project.

All proposals should have all of the following sections, it is recommended that you must follow the listed order, it ensures logical flow to your writing. It is also recommended that all proposals use headers for each section. When writing your proposal, take care to explain your rationale and justify your choice by applying in text citation and any major alternatives you are discarding.

Project work Writing Styles and Formatting

It is known that there are various styles and formats in scientific project writing. What is important is; however, being consistent in using styles and formatting. This means that rules need to be followed consistently in writing a proposal and project. The following rules are selected for simplicity and formality, and students should follow them strictly in preparing a proposal and project.

Font Type and Size

Texts for both the proposal and project should be presented with font size 12 and Times New Roman font face except the texts for the title/cover page, headings, sub-headings, and caption labels for figures, tables, and graphs where different line spacing and font size are used. The first-level heading (Heading 1) in the proposal and project are written in bold, upper case and 16 font size. Second-level headings (Heading 2) are written in bold title case with 14-point font size, and the first letter of each major word of the heading (except particles) is written in uppercase letters. The third level headings (Heading 3) are written in bold title case in 12-point font size. The fourth level and all remaining lower-level headings are written in 12-point font size in sentence case unless required by grammatical or nomenclatural rules.

Apart from this variation in font size and formatting, all caption labels, column headings of tables are written in the same way with heading 3. For headings 1-3, the texts should be aligned at the center. The entire text in the research proposal and thesis are written in 12-point font size with justified alignment. Underlining of headings, sub-headings, or captions of tables or figures is not necessary.

Margins

One by one inch (top, bottom, and left) but the right margin shall be 0.75 inches. The same margins should be applied to all pages including those of the figures and tables.

Headings and Sub-headings

The texts for each title of the preliminary sections and the chapters are written in 16-point bold uppercase letters and are aligned at the center. Texts for second and third-level headings are written in bold with 14 and 12 font sizes respectively and are aligned at the center. The chapter headings should be placed without a number. The second-level headings are numbered consecutively with Arabic numbers in an outline numbering system (e.g. 1.1., 1.2 and the like for subheading of chapter one and 2.1., 2.2 and the like for subheadings of chapter two and the like) to have a numbered subheading, there ought to be at least two subheadings (Heading 2 and Heading 3) under a higher level heading.

Line Spacing and Paragraph Format

Line spacing for the text should be 1.5. There must be (auto) line spacing between paragraphs and above and below all headings, subheadings, and caption labels. All paragraphs of the text should be in block paragraph format. This means, starting new paragraphs with indentation is not necessary.

Page Numbering and Setup

Each component of the preliminary section, each chapter of the thesis, the references, and the appendices must start on the new page. Except for the cover page of the proposal and the title page of the project, every page is assigned a page number.

Page number of the main body of the thesis, references, and appendices should be in Arabic number (1, 2, 3, and the like) and that of prefaces should be in lower case Roman numbers (i, ii, iii, and the like).

Tables and Figures

Tables should be used when displaying exact values is important or when clear patterns are not apparent in the numerical values. Figures should be used to indicate trends and patterns of given facts, models, or theories. However, it is not acceptable to use both tables and figures to present the same data. Tables and figures should be single-line spaced. Tables and figures should be consistent in format throughout the document. Tables and figures which are more than one-page length are discouraged. If a table and figure continue to the next page, the word table or figure with its number and the word “continued” should head the table or figure. But the column heading should appear on the continued page.

List of Acronyms and/or Abbreviations

This is a complete list of acronyms and abbreviations used in the report. Acronyms and abbreviations are written in alphabetical order of the words when written in full. Standard International (SI) units and elementary or obvious abbreviations and acronyms such as *et al.*, and the like, *e.g.*, *Ph.D.* and *prof.* should not be listed.

Components of Proposal

♣ Preliminaries

- ⑩ Cover page
- ⑩ Acknowledgment (optional)
- ⑩ Table of contents
- ⑩ List of tables (if any)
- ⑩ List of figures (if any)
- ⑩ List of acronyms/abbreviations (if any)
- ⑩ Abstract (Optional)

♣ Main body

- ⑩ Introduction
- ⑩ Description of the existing system
- ⑩ Statement of the Problem
- ⑩ Objectives of the Study
- ⑩ Significance of the project
- ⑩ Methodology
- ⑩ Proposed solution and anticipated results
- ⑩ Feasibility of the project
- ⑩ Schedule of activities and Gantt chart

Cover Page

**SALALE UNIVERSITY
COLLEGE OF NATURAL SCIENCE
DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE**

<16pts, upper case, bold>



Project Title

<14pts, 1st Letter of each word upper case, bold>

By

Full name of the student

< 14pts, 1st Letter of each word upper case, bold>

**Month, year
Fiche Ethiopia**

< 14pts, 1st Letter of each word upper case, bold>

Proposal Writing

Table of content

<The word “TABLE OF CONTENT” is in capital letters and bold print and centered on top of the page. The word “Page” is aligned to the right. This part shows the list of headings, subheadings and their corresponding page numbers. It must include all sections and subsections of the report, starting with the declaration and ending with a list of appendices. Heading 1, Heading 2, and Heading 3 in the main body of the project/proposal must be included in this part.>

Abstract (optional)

<Provide a brief summary of the project and the main points>

Introduction

Background Information

<Introduce the project and explain the context. What is background to the project? What are the problems experienced by the client, what does the client want to achieve? You need to demonstrate your understanding of the practical problem of the sponsor/client on your hand and your ability to select a topic that matches with the sponsor/client and the problem they are facing and for which it is possible to do a meaningful project that has the potential to yield results. It should state the key decisions that you will have to make and/or the main technical or other problems that you expect to have to solve.>

Description of the existing system

<If the project is to be conducted in a given area, the main features of the area have to be defined. Remember: In this subsection, the student should support its descriptions with the fitting map of the study area.>

Statement of the Problem

<Under the Statement of the problem, the student should clearly and precisely define the problem, showing the severity of the problem, presenting the extent of the problem and figuring out the gaps in the past project. (if)>

Objectives of the Study

<The goal of the project and main focused objectives of the project are discussed in this section>

- General Objectives
- Specific Objectives

Scope of the Project

<Scope defines what needs to be achieved and the work that must be done to deliver a project. It includes specific project goals, deliverables, features, functions, tasks, deadlines, and ultimately costs.>

Significance of the project

<Under the significance of the study, the student should focus on the contribution of the project to the society, who are going to be benefited from the study, the contribution of the project to the existing knowledge in the area, and the like.>

Methodology

<This section provides insight on what methodology you will employ in the development of the envisioned system. It is the systematic, theoretical analysis of the methods applied to yours of study. It can comprise of step by step procedures, flowcharts, block diagrams or algorithms of the proposed system.>

- Method of data collection
- Methods of systems design and development

Proposed solution and anticipated results

<This section describes what your envisioned system is supposed to achieve. You can give your system's functional requirements in this section.>

Feasibility of the project

<A feasibility study—sometimes called a feasibility analysis or feasibility report—is a way to evaluate whether or not a project plan could be successful. A feasibility study evaluates the practicality of your project plan in order to judge whether or not you're able to move forward with the project.>

- Technical Feasibility
- Operational feasibility
- Political feasibility
- Economic feasibility
- Legal feasibility

Schedule of activities and Gantt chart

<Provide schedule as per following format>

<Also provide Gantt chart to clearly illustrate the project schedule>

- Budget breakdown
- Work plan

Reference

<You must use references (IEEE style) when appropriate to justify your project >

Proposal Oral Presentation

Stylistic Issues: The Slide

Even though it is commonly called “oral presentation” An oral presentation is equally visual as it is an auditory medium. Therefore, emphasis should also be given to the way the slides are designed and presented. The slide should be visible and legible to the audience members sitting at the very back of the room. Therefore, there are certain points to consider:

Layout: The background color of the slide and the color of the text should have a sharp contrast. If the background of the slide is dark, then the text should be light in color and provide ample contrast (“light” does not necessarily mean “bright

Background: After you have chosen an appropriate background for your slides. Stick to your choice and use the same background throughout the presentation. Also, particularly for scientific presentations, a plain background is preferred (a gradient of the shades of the same color is also acceptable). If you are inclined to add a graphic, picture, and the like and the like in your background, make sure that it is subject-appropriate and does not draw attention away from the text and figures that you are attempting to communicate. Party balloons, a motorcycle flying off a cliff, and the like are not deemed appropriate.

Recommended Fonts and Sizes: The type and size of the font are equally important. Do not use script fonts; they may seem fancy on an invitation card but are unsuitable for professional/ scientific presentations. Select a font type that is easily legible and has sufficient spacing between letters (do not use condensed fonts, where one letter appears to overlap with the next). Using standard fonts, such as Arial, Tahoma, Gill Sans and Garamond are recommendable for effective slides. As to the font size, Titles 36 pt, Main bullets 28 pt, Sub-bullets 28 pt if room, otherwise 24 pt is recommendable. There is also a strong inclination to use bold font types throughout. A student should have to Keep text/title size consistent across slides.

Effective text slides: As stated earlier, the oral presentation is a visual as well as an auditory medium. Most of your slides should contain figures (whether images, graphs, or tables) whenever possible. You should limit the use of text-only to state the problem, frame the problem in the appropriate context, and summarize results, and state major conclusions. Even in cases where you need to use text, a slide with more than a few lines of text will bore your audience. The number of lines per slide should not be more than 6-8. State key concepts in bulleted phrases or short declarative statements and cover the details verbally.

The Presenter

An oral presentation is not only a presentation of the body of the students' work, but students are also presenting them as the person who conducted the project. So students should pay attention to their preventability as they do their work.

There are accepted norms that a presenter should generally follow. Primary among these is physical appearance. Try and dress appropriately. There is no defined dress code, but there are certain “don’ts” that you should always follow.

- Do not dress shabbily.
- Do not come with unkempt hair
- Do not wear slippers
- Do not wear jeans and a T-shirt, or other extremely casual clothing

Contents of the Oral Presentation

The presentation should include a short introduction, problems, project objectives, Scope and limitation, significance of a brief description of the methodology. The presentations schedule should be no more than **15 minutes** long. That’s not much time. Plan how many minutes you are going to spend per slide. The trick to giving good presentations is distilling your information down into a few bulleted lists, diagrams, tables, and graphs. You don’t want to be rushed while presenting.

Title slide (1 slide). One the title of the slide student will include the topic of the project, the names of students and advisors, degrees, department, the college and university names, etc.

Introduction: Under introduction, the undergraduate students are expected to brief orally present:

- Background of the study (1-3 slides)
- Statement of the problem (1-2 slides)
- The objective of the study (1-2 slide)
- Scope of the project (1 slide)
- Significance of the project (1 slide)
- Methodology (typically 3-5 slides)